

THE ETSY BUSINESS WORKBOOK

From First Listing to Full-Time Income

A Step-by-Step Planner for Building
Your Profitable Etsy Shop

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FINDING YOUR NICHE WORKSHEET

The best Etsy niches sit at the intersection of 3 things:

1. What you ENJOY making 2. What you are SKILLED at 3. What SELLS

BRAINSTORM - What I enjoy making/creating:

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____

MARKET RESEARCH - Search Etsy for each idea above:

Idea 1: # of results _____ Avg price \$ _____ Reviews on top items _____

Idea 2: # of results _____ Avg price \$ _____ Reviews on top items _____

Idea 3: # of results _____ Avg price \$ _____ Reviews on top items _____

Idea 4: # of results _____ Avg price \$ _____ Reviews on top items _____

SWEET SPOT: High demand (many reviews) + NOT oversaturated + good price

My chosen niche: _____

My unique angle (what makes mine different): _____

My target customer: _____

Problem I solve for them: _____

COMPETITOR 1

Shop name: _____ # Sales: _____

Best seller: _____ Price: \$ _____

What customers love (read reviews): _____

What customers complain about: _____

How I can do it BETTER: _____

COMPETITOR 2

Shop name: _____ # Sales: _____

Best seller: _____ Price: \$ _____

What customers love (read reviews): _____

What customers complain about: _____

How I can do it BETTER: _____

COMPETITOR 3

Shop name: _____ # Sales: _____

Best seller: _____ Price: \$ _____

What customers love (read reviews): _____

What customers complain about: _____

How I can do it BETTER: _____

COMPETITOR 4

Shop name: _____ # Sales: _____

Best seller: _____ Price: \$ _____

What customers love (read reviews): _____

What customers complain about: _____

How I can do it BETTER: _____

COMPETITOR 5

Shop name: _____ # Sales: _____

Best seller: _____ Price: \$ _____

What customers love (read reviews): _____

What customers complain about: _____

How I can do it BETTER: _____

PRICING CALCULATOR

Pricing formula: Materials + Labor + Fees + Profit = Price

PRODUCT 1: _____

Materials cost: \$ _____

Labor (hours ____ x \$ ____/hr): \$ _____

Packaging/shipping materials: \$ _____

Etsy listing fee (\$0.20): \$0.20

Etsy transaction fee (6.5%): \$ _____

Payment processing (3% + \$0.25): \$ _____

Etsy ads (if used, 15% of sale): \$ _____

TOTAL COSTS: \$ _____

Desired profit margin (____ %): \$ _____

FINAL PRICE: \$ _____

Competitor average price: \$ _____ [] Competitive? Y/N

PRODUCT 2: _____

Materials cost: \$ _____

Labor (hours ____ x \$ ____/hr): \$ _____

Packaging/shipping materials: \$ _____

Etsy listing fee (\$0.20): \$0.20

Etsy transaction fee (6.5%): \$ _____

Payment processing (3% + \$0.25): \$ _____

Etsy ads (if used, 15% of sale): \$ _____

TOTAL COSTS: \$ _____

Desired profit margin (____ %): \$ _____

FINAL PRICE: \$ _____

Competitor average price: \$ _____ [] Competitive? Y/N

PRODUCT 3: _____

Materials cost: \$ _____

Labor (hours ____ x \$ ____/hr): \$ _____

Packaging/shipping materials: \$ _____

Etsy listing fee (\$0.20): \$0.20

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Etsy ads (if used, 15% of sale): \$ _____

TOTAL COSTS: \$ _____

Desired profit margin (____ %): \$ _____

FINAL PRICE: \$ _____

Competitor average price: \$ _____ [] Competitive? Y/N

SEO KEYWORD RESEARCH WORKSHEET

Etsy SEO = being found in search. You get 13 TAGS per listing.

Use long-tail keywords (2-3 words) that describe your item.

LISTING 1: _____

Search terms customers would type:

Tag 1: _____

Tag 2: _____

Tag 3: _____

Tag 4: _____

Tag 5: _____

Tag 6: _____

Tag 7: _____

Tag 8: _____

Tag 9: _____

Tag 10: _____

Tag 11: _____

Tag 12: _____

Tag 13: _____

Title (front-load best keywords): _____

LISTING 2: _____

Search terms customers would type:

Tag 1: _____

Tag 2: _____

Tag 3: _____

Tag 4: _____

Tag 5: _____

Tag 6: _____

Tag 7: _____

Tag 8: _____

Tag 9: _____

Tag 10: _____

Tag 11: _____

Tag 12: _____

Tag 13: _____

Title (front-load best keywords): _____

LISTING CREATION TEMPLATE

LISTING TITLE (140 chars max, best keywords first):

PHOTOS CHECKLIST:

- ☐ Main photo (clean, bright, shows full product)
- ☐ Lifestyle photo (product in use)
- ☐ Scale photo (shows size clearly)
- ☐ Detail/texture close-up
- ☐ Packaging photo
- ☐ Size chart or comparison
- ☐ Process/behind-the-scenes
- ☐ Text overlay with key features
- ☐ Video (up to 15 seconds)

DESCRIPTION FORMULA:

Paragraph 1: Hook - What problem does this solve?

Paragraph 2: Features & details

Paragraph 3: Size/dimensions/materials

Paragraph 4: Shipping & processing time

Paragraph 5: Call to action + shop policies

Category: _____ Price: \$ _____ Quantity: _____

Processing time: _____ days Shipping: ☐ Free ☐ Calculated

SHOP BRANDING WORKSHEET

SHOP NAME: _____

(Available on Etsy? [] Yes [] No Backup: _____)

BRAND PERSONALITY (circle 3-5 words):

Playful / Elegant / Minimalist / Rustic / Modern / Luxurious /

Whimsical / Earthy / Bold / Sophisticated / Cozy / Professional

COLOR PALETTE (choose 3-5 colors):

Primary: _____ Secondary: _____ Accent: _____

FONTS:

Headings: _____ Body: _____

MY BRAND STORY (why I started this shop):

TARGET CUSTOMER AVATAR:

Name: _____ Age: _____ Gender: _____

Interests: _____

Where they shop: _____

What they value: _____

Price sensitivity: Low / Medium / High

MY UNIQUE SELLING PROPOSITION (USP):

'I help [target customer] get [benefit] through [your product]'

PRODUCT PHOTOGRAPHY CHECKLIST

Great photos = more sales. Follow this checklist for every product:

SETUP:

- ☐ Natural light (near window, no direct sun)
- ☐ Clean background (white poster board or styled flat-lay)
- ☐ Tripod or stable surface (no blurry photos!)
- ☐ Props that match brand aesthetic (not distracting)
- ☐ Product clean and lint-free

SHOT LIST (aim for 8-10 photos per listing):

- ☐ Front view - full product, clean background
- ☐ Back view - show all details
- ☐ Close-up - texture, quality, craftsmanship
- ☐ Scale shot - next to ruler, hand, or common object
- ☐ In-use / lifestyle shot
- ☐ Packaging - how it arrives
- ☐ Multiple color/variation options
- ☐ Flat-lay with coordinating items
- ☐ Detail of any customization options
- ☐ Infographic with dimensions/features

EDITING:

- ☐ Brightness/contrast adjusted (bright but not washed out)
- ☐ White balance corrected (true colors)
- ☐ Cropped consistently (square or 4:3)
- ☐ Watermark added (optional, subtle if used)
- ☐ Saved at high resolution

TIP: Batch photograph! Do all products same day, same setup.

MONTHLY FINANCIAL TRACKER

Month: _____ Year: _____

Category	Amount	Notes
REVENUE		
Total Sales Revenue	\$ _____	_____
Number of Orders	\$ _____	_____
Average Order Value	\$ _____	_____
EXPENSES		
Materials/Supplies	\$ _____	_____
Etsy Fees (listing + transaction)	\$ _____	_____
Payment Processing Fees	\$ _____	_____
Shipping Costs	\$ _____	_____
Packaging Materials	\$ _____	_____
Advertising/Etsy Ads	\$ _____	_____
Tools/Software	\$ _____	_____
Other Expenses	\$ _____	_____
TOTAL REVENUE	\$ _____	
TOTAL EXPENSES	\$ _____	
NET PROFIT	\$ _____	
Profit Margin (%)	\$ _____	

MARKETING PLAN

PINTEREST STRATEGY (top traffic source for Etsy):

Account: _____ Boards created: _____

Pinning schedule: _____ pins/day Best times: _____

Keywords for pin descriptions: _____

INSTAGRAM STRATEGY:

Account: @_____ Posting: ____x/week

Content mix: ____% product, ____% behind scenes, ____% educational

Hashtag groups saved: [] Yes

Reels/video content plan: _____

EMAIL LIST:

Platform (Mailchimp/ConvertKit): _____

Lead magnet (freebie to attract subscribers): _____

Email frequency: Weekly / Bi-weekly / Monthly

Content: New products / Sales / Tips / Behind the scenes

ETSY ADS BUDGET:

Daily budget: \$_____

Only advertise listings with: [] Good reviews [] High margins

Review ad performance: Weekly / Monthly

COLLABORATIONS / CROSS-PROMOTION:

Complementary shops to partner with: _____

Influencer outreach plan: _____

CUSTOMER SERVICE SCRIPTS

RESPONSE TO POSITIVE REVIEW:

'Thank you so much, [Name]! I am thrilled you love your [product].
Your kind words made my day! Enjoy, and I am here if you ever need
anything. ~ [Your name]'

RESPONSE TO NEGATIVE REVIEW:

'I am so sorry your experience was not what you expected, [Name].
I would love to make this right. Please message me directly so we
can find a solution. Your satisfaction matters to me.'

SHIPPING DELAY MESSAGE:

'Hi [Name], Thank you for your order! I wanted to let you know
that [reason] may add 1-2 days to processing. Your item will ship
by [date]. I appreciate your patience!'

CUSTOM ORDER INQUIRY:

'Hi [Name]! Thank you for reaching out about a custom order.
I would love to help! Here are a few questions: [questions].
Custom orders typically take [X] days and start at \$[X].
Let me know if you would like to proceed!'

OUT OF STOCK / DISCONTINUED:

'Hi [Name], Thank you for your interest in [product]! Unfortunately
this item is currently out of stock. I expect it back by [date].
Would you like me to message you when it is available?'

SCALING YOUR ETSY BUSINESS

WHEN TO SCALE (check all that apply):

- ☐ Consistently selling 20+ items/month
- ☐ Getting repeat customers
- ☐ Can not keep up with demand
- ☐ Want to quit day job
- ☐ Have systems in place for fulfillment

SCALING STRATEGIES:

- ☐ Expand product line (add variations/sizes/colors)
- ☐ Raise prices (test 10-20% increase)
- ☐ Hire help (VA, production assistant, shipper)
- ☐ Batch production (make 50 at once vs 1 at a time)
- ☐ Add digital products (higher margin, no shipping)
- ☐ Open second sales channel (website, Amazon Handmade)
- ☐ Wholesale to local shops
- ☐ Offer bundles and gift sets

SYSTEMS TO BUILD BEFORE SCALING:

- ☐ Inventory tracking system
- ☐ Standard operating procedures (SOPs) for each task
- ☐ Financial tracking (separate business bank account)
- ☐ Customer service templates
- ☐ Shipping station and supplies stocked
- ☐ Time tracking (know your hourly rate)

MY NEXT SCALING STEP: _____

By when: ____/____/____ Resources needed: _____

MONTHLY GOALS - MONTH 1

Month: _____ Year: _____

REVENUE GOAL: \$ _____ ORDERS GOAL: _____

NEW LISTINGS GOAL: _____ REVIEWS GOAL: _____

TOP 3 PRIORITIES THIS MONTH:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WEEKLY ACTION ITEMS:

Week 1:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 2:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 3:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 4:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

END OF MONTH REVIEW:

Revenue achieved: \$ _____ Orders: _____ New listings: _____

What worked: _____

What to improve: _____

Next month focus: _____

MONTHLY GOALS - MONTH 2

Month: _____ Year: _____

REVENUE GOAL: \$ _____ ORDERS GOAL: _____

NEW LISTINGS GOAL: _____ REVIEWS GOAL: _____

TOP 3 PRIORITIES THIS MONTH:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WEEKLY ACTION ITEMS:

Week 1:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 2:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 3:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 4:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

END OF MONTH REVIEW:

Revenue achieved: \$ _____ Orders: _____ New listings: _____

What worked: _____

What to improve: _____

Next month focus: _____

MONTHLY GOALS - MONTH 3

Month: _____ Year: _____

REVENUE GOAL: \$ _____ ORDERS GOAL: _____

NEW LISTINGS GOAL: _____ REVIEWS GOAL: _____

TOP 3 PRIORITIES THIS MONTH:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WEEKLY ACTION ITEMS:

Week 1:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 2:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 3:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 4:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

END OF MONTH REVIEW:

Revenue achieved: \$ _____ Orders: _____ New listings: _____

What worked: _____

What to improve: _____

Next month focus: _____

MONTHLY GOALS - MONTH 4

Month: _____ Year: _____

REVENUE GOAL: \$ _____ ORDERS GOAL: _____

NEW LISTINGS GOAL: _____ REVIEWS GOAL: _____

TOP 3 PRIORITIES THIS MONTH:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WEEKLY ACTION ITEMS:

Week 1:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 2:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 3:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 4:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

END OF MONTH REVIEW:

Revenue achieved: \$ _____ Orders: _____ New listings: _____

What worked: _____

What to improve: _____

Next month focus: _____

MONTHLY GOALS - MONTH 5

Month: _____ Year: _____

REVENUE GOAL: \$ _____ ORDERS GOAL: _____

NEW LISTINGS GOAL: _____ REVIEWS GOAL: _____

TOP 3 PRIORITIES THIS MONTH:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WEEKLY ACTION ITEMS:

Week 1:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 2:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 3:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 4:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

END OF MONTH REVIEW:

Revenue achieved: \$ _____ Orders: _____ New listings: _____

What worked: _____

What to improve: _____

Next month focus: _____

MONTHLY GOALS - MONTH 6

Month: _____ Year: _____

REVENUE GOAL: \$ _____ ORDERS GOAL: _____

NEW LISTINGS GOAL: _____ REVIEWS GOAL: _____

TOP 3 PRIORITIES THIS MONTH:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WEEKLY ACTION ITEMS:

Week 1:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 2:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 3:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Week 4:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

END OF MONTH REVIEW:

Revenue achieved: \$ _____ Orders: _____ New listings: _____

What worked: _____

What to improve: _____

Next month focus: _____

90-DAY LAUNCH PLAN

DAYS 1-30: FOUNDATION

- ☐ Set up Etsy shop (banner, bio, policies)
- ☐ Complete branding worksheet
- ☐ Create first 10 listings with optimized SEO
- ☐ Set up social media accounts (Instagram + Pinterest)
- ☐ Photograph all current products
- ☐ Set up financial tracking system
- ☐ Join 3 Etsy seller Facebook groups

DAYS 31-60: GROWTH

- ☐ Add 10 more listings (goal: 20 total)
- ☐ Get first 5 sales (offer opening sale discount)
- ☐ Start Etsy ads (\$1-2/day budget)
- ☐ Post daily on Pinterest (5+ pins)
- ☐ Begin email list with lead magnet
- ☐ Reach out to 5 potential collaborators
- ☐ Analyze which listings perform best

DAYS 61-90: OPTIMIZATION

- ☐ Add 10 more listings (goal: 30 total)
- ☐ Optimize underperforming listings (new photos/tags)
- ☐ Request reviews from happy customers
- ☐ Launch seasonal or trending product
- ☐ Calculate true profit margins
- ☐ Plan next 90 days based on data
- ☐ Celebrate your progress!

90-DAY REVENUE TARGET: \$ _____

Actual revenue achieved: \$ _____